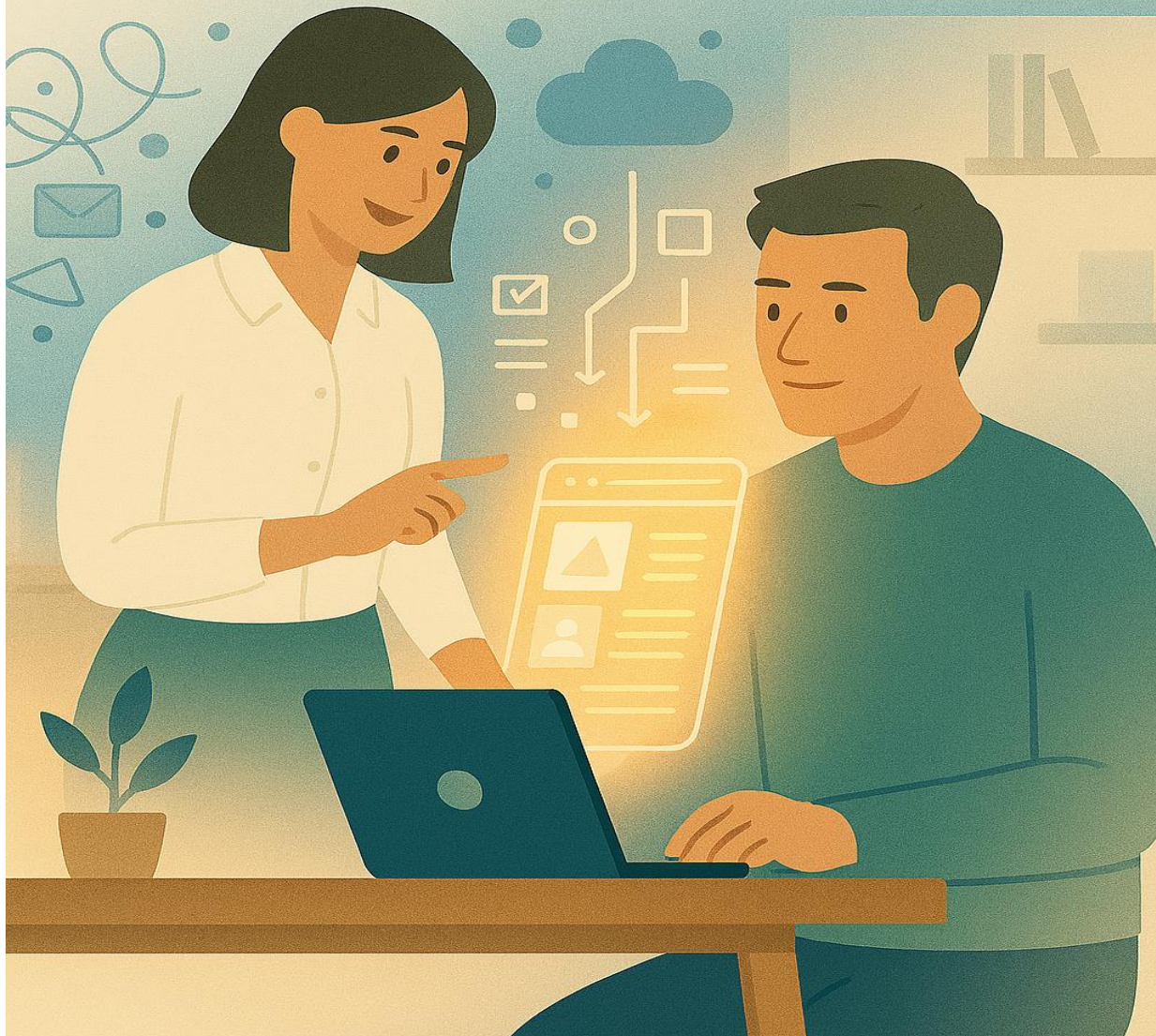


BUSINESS ANALYSIS CASE STUDY

When My Father Became My Client –

Applying Business Analysis at Home



Business Analysis | Real-World Application | Personal Project

Executive Summary

This case study illustrates how **Business Analysis principles** can be effectively applied outside traditional corporate settings to improve real-life processes. It focuses on helping a retired senior citizen transition from long-standing manual practices to a modern, digital-first workflow.

By applying core BA competencies—such as **Stakeholder Analysis, Current-State Assessment, Gap Analysis, Requirements Prioritization, and Agile Iterative Refinement**—the project successfully bridged the gap between legacy methods and today's digital demands. Through structured elicitation, solution design, prototyping, and user-centric testing, a simplified and sustainable operating model was created.

The outcome was a system that empowered the user to navigate digital platforms with confidence and independence, significantly reducing frustration, errors, and reliance on external assistance. This study highlights how analytical thinking, user empathy, and structured BA frameworks can generate meaningful impact in any domain—even within a household—proving that Business Analysis is not limited to projects, but is a mindset for solving real-world problems.

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1. Introduction & Business Context: Navigating the Digital Shift.

Business Analysis doesn't always start in the boardroom — sometimes, it starts in your own living room. After decades of loyal service in the banking sector, my father retired with dignity. Instead of ease, he faced the challenge of **The Digital Shift**—navigating new HRMS portals, digital KYC, and app-based medical benefits. For someone accustomed to manual processes, every step felt like a maze.

Stepping Into the BA Role I decided to approach this transition as a Business Analyst, prioritizing empathy and structure:

- **Active Listening:** Deeply sought to understand the "**why**" behind his struggles.
- **Stakeholder Mapping:** Identified key parties, from my mother (our in-house legacy expert) to supportive bank officials.
- **Context Gathering:** Reviewed old forms and documents to understand the original, manual process.
- **Facilitation:** Guided the adoption process, ensuring adaptation occurred at his own pace.

Reflection I realized that BA concepts were actively transforming how I solved problems at home. Business Analysis is a **mindset for structured problem-solving**.

BA Competencies: Active Listening | Stakeholder Analysis | Requirements Elicitation | Context Gathering | Empathy-Driven Analysis | Change Management.

Key Takeaway: Applying a Business Analyst mindset transformed our real-life challenges into step-by-step solutions, proving that structured analysis drives positive change anywhere.

2. Process Assessment: Mapping As-Is and To-Be States

Effective business analysis begins with understanding both the process and the people behind it.

Step 1: Stakeholder Engagement I engaged key stakeholders to ensure every process and perspective was captured:

- **Primary User (Father):** Focus on daily challenges, specific needs, and desired outcomes.
- **Legacy Expert (Mother):** Provided historical context and manual workarounds.
- **External SMEs (Bank/Medical Teams):** Clarified digital processes, system constraints, and support resources.

Step 2: Requirements Elicitation I used multiple techniques to capture comprehensive needs:

Interviews & Observation to identify hidden pain points, **Document Analysis** to review legacy processes, and **Group Discussions** to define the ideal future state.

Step 3: Current-State Assessment and Gap Analysis

- **As-Is (Current State):** Documented reliance on paper, frequent password resets, difficulty with KYC renewals, and high dependence on external assistance.
- **To-Be (Future State):** The blueprint focused on a smoother, more efficient experience: centralizing documents and automating reminders.
- **Gap Analysis:** Highlighted critical areas: **Account Access** (password resets), **Information Scatter**, **Process Ambiguity**, and **Technical Confidence**.

BA Competencies: Stakeholder Identification & Engagement | Current-State Assessment | Observation | Document Analysis | Process Mapping | Gap Analysis | Requirements Gathering.

Key Takeaway: Effective business analysis requires active stakeholder involvement and proven elicitation techniques to map current and future states, enabling clear, actionable steps for meaningful change.

3. Requirements Documentation, Validation, and Prioritization

Turning stakeholder conversations into clear, prioritized requirements is crucial for solution design.

Step 1: Business Requirements Documentation (BRD) All inputs were consolidated into a BRD, focused on one primary objective: Enable secure and user-friendly digital management of post-retirement tasks.

- **Functional Requirements:** Provide secure, centralized cloud storage; send automated reminders; enable easy password reset; and maintain a clear help directory.
- **Non-Functional Requirements:** **Usability** (large fonts, simple navigation); **Security** (data backup); **Clarity** (plain language).
- **Transition Requirements:** Outline how **paper records** could be **migrated** to a digital storage system with minimal workflow disruption.

Step 2: Prioritization Using MoSCoW Method Requirements were classified to focus effort on highest value features:

- **Must Have:** Secure storage, simple password reset, timely reminders.
- **Should Have:** Help contact directory, easy instructions.
- **Could Have:** Personalization (font size adjustment).
- **Won't Have:** Features like Advanced AI-based assistance were excluded from this phase.

Step 3: Validation & Alignment (RACI) I reviewed the BRD with family and support staff to ensure accuracy. A simple **RACI chart** ensured all stakeholders understood their responsibilities during the transition phase.

The RACI Chart is a key tool for clarifying roles and responsibilities in any project. It defines who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed. This ensures every task has clear ownership.

- **Responsible (R):** The person who does the work.
- **Accountable (A):** The person who owns the decision and approves the work.
- **Consulted (C):** The people whose opinions are sought (two-way).
- **Informed (I):** The people who are simply kept up-to-date (one-way).

BA Competencies: Business Requirements Documentation (BRD) | Requirements Prioritization (MoSCoW) | Validation & Stakeholder Alignment | Role Definition (RACI).

Key Takeaway: A clear, prioritized BRD validated by stakeholders and guided by a simple RACI matrix ensures the solution meets real needs and clarifies roles, providing a strong foundation for design.

Figure 3.1: Stakeholder Use Case Diagram (Conceptual View)

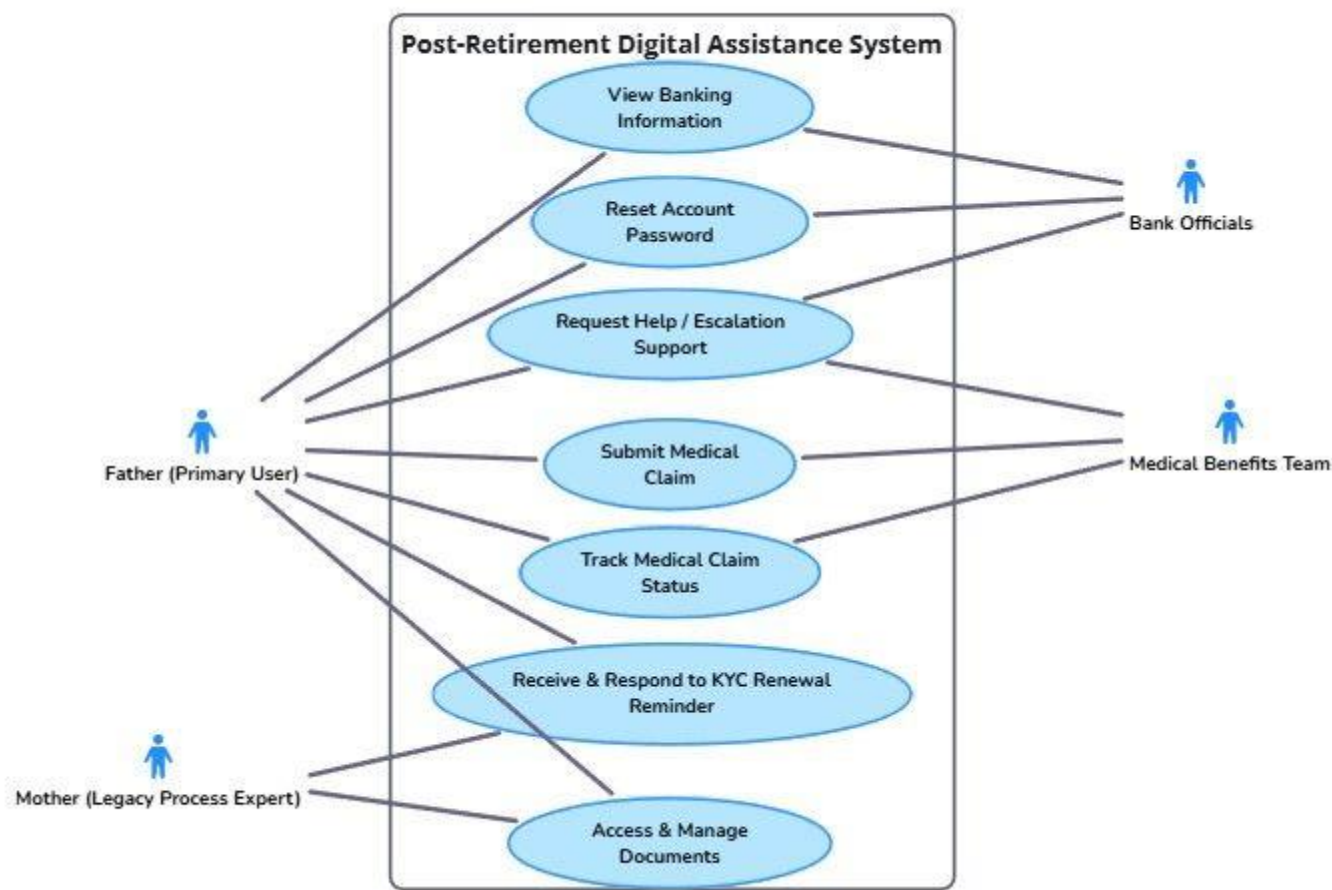


Figure 3.2: RACI Matrix Sample (Template for Reference)

Activity	Father (User)	Mother (Legacy Expert)	Bank Officials	Medical Benefits Team	BA / Analyst (You)
1. Requirements Gathering	C	C	C	C	A, R
2. Requirements Documentation (BRD)	I	I	I	I	A, R
3. Prioritization (MoSCoW)	C	C	C	C	A, R
4. Validation Walkthroughs	C	C	C	C	A, R
5. Final Approval	A	I	I	I	R

4. Solution Design and Prototyping

The next step was translating validated requirements into practical, easy-to-use designs, with usability remaining the top priority.

Step 1: Solution Design & Wireframing - I defined the key components of the digital system with simplicity and accessibility in mind: a **clean dashboard**, easy **document upload** with large labels, and a **straightforward reminder setup**.

Step 2: User Flow Mapping - I mapped out the **logical user journey** (e.g., App start → Login → Task → Logout) to minimize complexity and ensure an **end-to-end flow** that was simple, well-labeled, and logical for the user.

Step 3: Prototyping & Iterative Feedback - I built a simple mockup for testing real tasks (like uploading documents). Feedback from the user was immediately incorporated (e.g., larger buttons, easier access to help) to refine the prototype iteratively.

Step 4: Fit-Gap Analysis and Risk Mitigation

The prototype was evaluated against the BRD to ensure alignment (**Fit-Gap Analysis**). Key **risks** were assessed and mitigations planned:

- **Risk (Access):** Forgetting passwords → **Mitigation:** Biometric login option.
- **Risk (Usability):** Confusing icons → **Mitigation:** Clear labels and buttons.
- **Risk (Reliability):** Internet issues → **Mitigation:** Offline help guide.

Step 5: Action Planning

A clear plan was created for implementation, including account setup, initial **data migration** (scanning/uploading documents), **in-person training**, and providing a **troubleshooting guide** for ongoing support.

BA Competencies: Solution Design | Prototyping | Feedback Collection | Fit-Gap Analysis | Risk Analysis | Change Management.

Key Takeaway: Validating prototypes with real users and integrating risk mitigation ensures the solution is practical, risk-aware, and perfectly aligned with stakeholder needs.

Figure 4.1: Conceptual Wireframes and Prototypes (Reference Visuals)

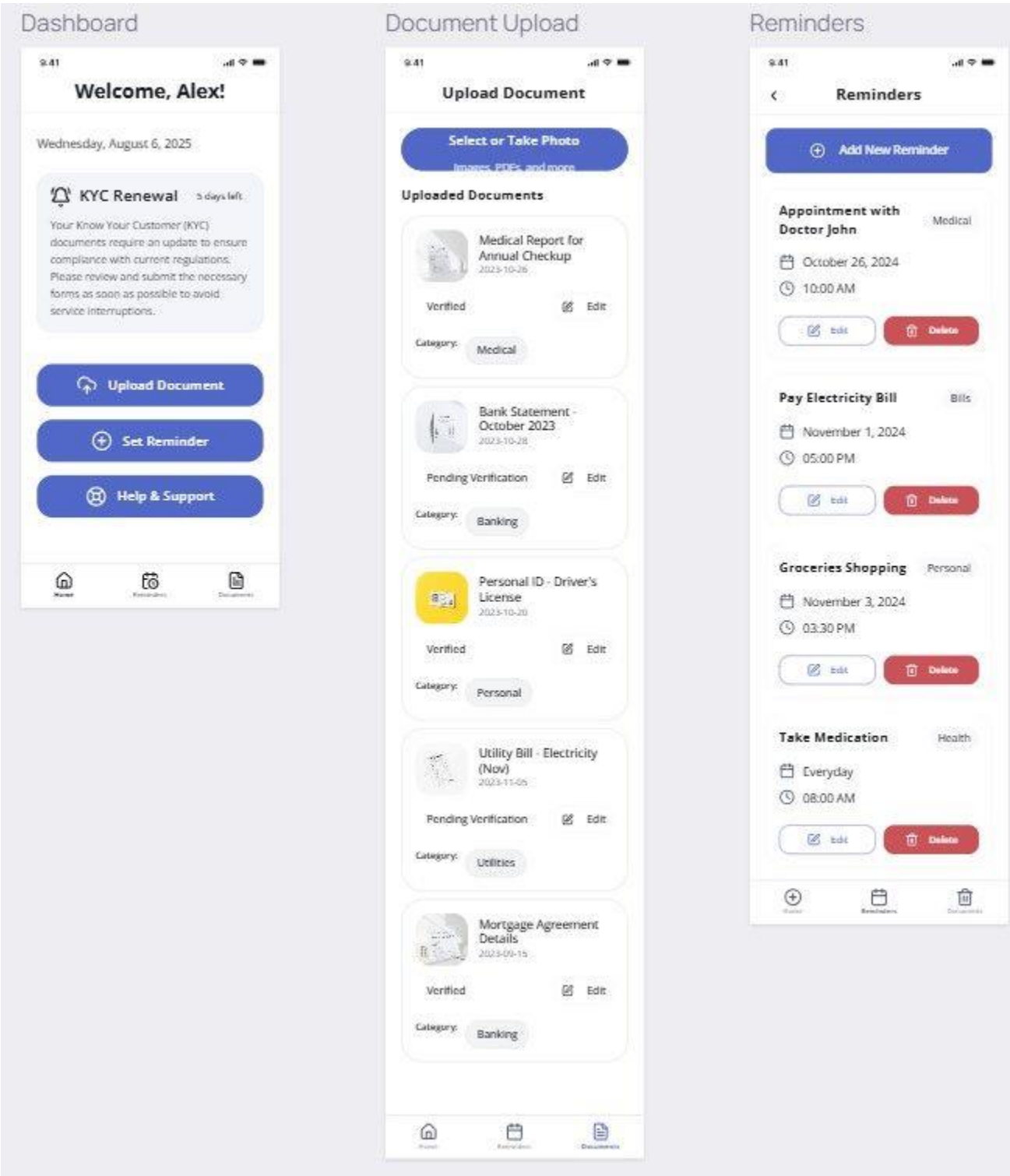
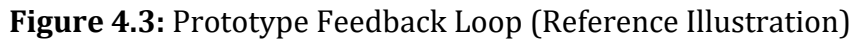


Figure 4.3: Prototype Feedback Loop (Reference Illustration)



```

graph LR
    A[Create Prototype  
(Designer / Business Analyst)] --> B[Stakeholders Test Prototype  
(Father, Family Users)]
    B --> C[Collect Feedback  
(All Users & Observers)]
    C --> D[Analyze & Identify Improvements  
(Analyst / Designer Team)]
    D --> E[Refine Prototype  
(Designer / Business Analyst)]
    E -.->|Iterative Feedback Loop| B
  
```

```

graph LR
    A[Objective: Verify prototype coverage vs BRD] --> B[Current State: Prototype features]
    B --> C[Future State: Business requirements]
    C --> D[Gaps Identified]
    D --> E[Action Plan: Adjustments to close gaps]
    E --> F[Risks Identified]
    F --> G1[Risk: Forgetting passwords]
    F --> G2[Risk: Connectivity Issues]
    F --> G3[Risk: Confusing Icons]
    F --> H[Mitigations]
    G1 --> I1[Biometric login]
    G2 --> I2[Offline help guide]
    G3 --> I3[Clear labels and buttons]
    H --> J[Outcome: Meets requirements & user challenges]
  
```

5. Agile Framework: Epics, User Stories, and Acceptance Criteria

Framing requirements as Agile artifacts ensured that ideas were clear, testable, and delivered tangible value.

Step 1: Epics (High-level themes)

In Agile, Epics represent high-level themes that group related needs and features.

- **Document Management** — Uploading, storing, and retrieving important documents.
- **Reminders & Notifications** — Setting and receiving alerts for key dates.
- **Help & Support** — Providing guidance when users feel stuck.

Step 2: User Stories Requirements were written from the user's perspective (*As a [user], I want [action], so that [value]*):

- As a user, I want to **upload my ID documents** so that I can access them easily when needed.
- As a user, I want to **set reminders for renewals** so that I don't miss important deadlines.
- As a user, I want to **reset my password easily** so that I am not locked out of my accounts.

Step 3: Acceptance Criteria

To confirm when a User Story is considered "done," I applied the "**Given-When-Then**" format, defining clear, testable conditions for each major feature:

- **Story: Upload Documents:** Given the user is logged in, when a file is uploaded, then the document is saved and visible on the dashboard within three steps.
- **Story: Set Reminders:** Given a renewal reminder is created, when the date approaches, then the user receives an automatic notification at the configured time.
- **Story: Access Help:** Given the user clicks the "Help" button, when the support page opens, then clear instructions or contact information should be displayed immediately.

BA Competencies: Agile Analysis Techniques | Epics & User Story Writing | Acceptance Criteria Definition | Requirements Management.

Key Takeaway: Clear requirements, framed as Agile artifacts, turn ideas into actionable solutions—ensuring usability, reducing ambiguity, and delivering real value.

6. Adoption, Support, and Sustainability

The final stage ensured a smooth transition, evaluated effectiveness, and planned for ongoing growth—the true measure of a solution's success.

1. Solution Handover and User Enablement

With the solution finalized, the focus shifted to **user enablement** to ensure **sustained adoption**:

- **Finalized Setup:** Simplified the **login process** and finalized user profiles for easy access.
- **Initial Data Organization:** Organized **key documents**, initial data, and reminders within the system.
- **Hands-on Training:** Provided a practical, **hands-on walkthrough** of everyday tasks, answering questions and demonstrating solutions.
- **Independent Use:** Shared a simple **troubleshooting guide** and clear instructions to ensure the client could use and maintain the system **independently** with **minimal ongoing help**.

2. Post-Implementation Support and Change Management

Systematic change management ensured the solution adapted successfully to real-life use:

- **Feedback Collection:** Collected detailed **feedback** from the user and family after the first week, logging all suggestions for refinement.
- **Prioritized Updates:** **Prioritized improvements** (e.g., simplifying reminders, adjusting font sizes) and implemented **timely updates** based on the feedback log.
- **Continuous Review:** **Reviewed** all changes with users to confirm their **effectiveness** and **positive impact**.
- **Ongoing Support:** Provided simple support through a **one-page guide** and remained available for quick troubleshooting.

3. Evaluation, UAT, and Sustainability

- **Informal User Acceptance (UAT):** Acceptance was confirmed through the client's direct, hands-on involvement in prototyping and post-implementation walkthroughs, which validated that the solution was practical, accessible, and met their needs effectively.
- **Measuring Success:** Success was evaluated by observing smoother task completion, improved document management, fewer missed deadlines, and noting a marked reduction in user confusion and support needs compared to the manual process.
- **Sustainability:** The solution was designed for sustainability through regular check-ins to capture evolving needs and a commitment to continuous simplification and refinement.

BA Competencies: Solution Handover | User Training | Change Management | User Acceptance Testing (Informal) | Evaluation | Continuous Improvement | Stakeholder Engagement | Communication & Documentation.

Key Takeaway: Delivering a solution is just the start—the real impact comes from supporting adoption, listening actively, and refining continuously to ensure the solution lasts and grows with its users.

7. Conclusion: Value Creation Through Business Analysis

This project, rooted in a personal household need, served as a high-stakes, real-world testing ground for my Business Analysis proficiency. It was far more than a case study; it was a catalyst for my professional development, solidifying my readiness to transition into a full-time role focused on driving structured, positive change.

Analytical Rigor and Technical Bridge-Building

I gained **analytical and critical confidence** by successfully translating ambiguous user frustration into structured, actionable components. Utilizing tools like **Current-State Assessment** and **Gap Analysis**, I proved the ability to target **root causes** and structure ambiguity—a critical skill for any BA. Crucially, I mastered the responsibility of the BA to **bridge the business and technical domains**. By moving from qualitative needs to precise, measurable **Acceptance Criteria**, I ensured the solution design was perfectly aligned with the client's business needs.

Stakeholder Leadership and Client Interaction

My first significant learning was the critical importance of **client interaction** and **empathy**. Engaging a diverse stakeholder group, I honed my **interpersonal and facilitation skills**, teaching me how to **actively listen** to anxieties and **build consensus**. This experience instilled the professional confidence necessary to effectively elicit needs, handle conflicting perspectives, and guide stakeholders toward a sustainable solution, which is key to success in any leadership-driven role.

Final Reflection: Career Competence Demonstrated

This initiative affirmed that Business Analysis is not a checklist of tasks, but a **proactive mindset focused on continuous value creation**. It reinforced the understanding that successful BA work requires **decisiveness, strategic thinking**, and a commitment to **empathy-driven decision-making**.

This case study demonstrates how core BA competencies, when applied with empathy and structure, can create sustainable impact in real-life situations well beyond traditional corporate projects. I am prepared to leverage this proven, structured approach to drive performance, manage change, and create sustainable value in a professional capacity, and I look forward to contributing immediately to strategic project success.